WASHINGTON · IN-HOME SERVICES AGENCY LICENSE (HOME CARE)

Washington Home Care License Readiness Checklist

Everything the Washington State Department of Health will expect to find in place before it licenses a non-medical home care agency under Chapter 70.127 RCW and Chapter 246-335 WAC — in one page, so you can tick it off before you apply and before any inspection. From AutoloomStudio, the makers of the Washington policy and procedure manual.

Before you apply — and before any inspection

- [ ] Entity formed; UBI number and FEIN obtained; a current business licence held for each office location from the state and any ...
- [ ] In-state main office chosen where records will be kept, secured and accessible; any branch office named ...
- [ ] Commercial general liability insurance in force at the rule's minimum ($1,000,000 per occurrence ...
- [ ] DOH orientation class attended and the certificate of completion in hand, dated within the last twelve months
- [ ] Administrator named (a home care employee meeting the Agency's own qualification) with a written alternate ...
- [ ] Washington State Patrol criminal history background check and DOH Disclosure Statement 505-055 obtained for the administrator and ...
- [ ] Organizational chart or narrative written, naming officers, administrator and alternate ...
- [ ] Management-and-supervision description written for each county to the four criteria — intake and plan of care ...
- [ ] Every option switch decided and written into the plan of operation and services statement ...
- [ ] Manual adopted and customised — agency name, counties, hours, services, switches ...
- [ ] Application 505-051 (type "New") and FTE worksheet 505-137 completed and signed ...
- [ ] Two complete personnel files assembled in the ten-item order, with the administrator's and supervisor's designations, alternates ...
- [ ] Hiring system ready before the first worker: application with references and credential search; applicant notice ...
- [ ] Training and certification tracking ready: two orientation hours and three safety hours before any care ...
- [ ] Agency orientation, TB training, confidentiality agreement, written test and skills verification checklist ready for every worker ...
- [ ] Client packet ready: written bill of rights with the nineteen rights, the supervisor's name and contact method ...
- [ ] Reporting routes written into the policies and taught at orientation: suspected abandonment, abuse ...
- [ ] Emergency preparedness plan, bloodborne pathogens exposure control plan and infection-control checklist complete ...
- [ ] Licence and compliance calendar set: twelve-month initial expiry; renewal date thirty days before expiry ...
- [ ] Marketing and website use "home care" and "in-home services" only after the licence issues ...

Key contacts (verify at the time of use)

- DOH In-Home Services licensing (Health Systems Quality Assurance) — questions on the application, service areas, changes and renewals: 360-236-2957; In-Home Services mailbox inhomeservices@doh.wa.gov (also for queries about the orientation class and how to register); P.O. Box 47852, Olympia, WA 98504-7852; physical address Town Center 2, 111 Israel Rd. S.E., Tumwater, WA 98501
- Mailing the application with payment: Department of Health, P.O. Box 1099, Olympia, WA 98507-1099 — check or money order payable to the Department of Health; later documents: In-Home Services Credentialing, P.O. Box 47877, Olympia, WA 98504-7877; phone 360-236-4700; no e-mail route for applications (DOH 505-052, April 2026)
- DOH customer service and complaints about a licensed agency or a credentialed professional: 360-236-4700 and the online complaint form at https://doh.wa.gov/licenses-permits-and-certificates/file-complaint-about-provider-or-facility/complaint-forms; the "department's complaint hotline number" that the bill of rights must carry (WAC 246-335-435(18)) was not found as a distinct toll-free number [DOH complaint hotline — verify with DOH before printing F-32; never print an unverified number]
- DSHS End Harm hotline (the "DSHS end harm hotline number" for the bill of rights, WAC 246-335-435(19)): 1-866-363-4276 (1-866-ENDHARM); DSHS Adult Protective Services central intake: 1-877-734-6277 and online intake; emergencies — 9-1-1; children — DCYF intake under chapter 26.44 RCW (DSHS Mandatory Reporting Contacts sheet — verify)
- DOH home care aide credential search (verification that a worker's certification is current and in good standing, WAC 246-335-425(5)):; DOH rulemaking contact for the ESSB 5271 enforcement and background-check rulemaking (CR-101 WSR 25-17-068): Julie Tomaro, julie.tomaro@doh.wa.gov, 360-236-2937, PO Box 47843, Olympia, WA 98504-7843; sign up for the "In-Home Services" GovDelivery topic at doh.wa.gov
- DOH pages: Home Care Agencies https://doh.wa.gov/licenses-permits-and-certificates/facilities-z/home-care-agencies; License Requirements .../home-care-agencies/license-requirements; Orientation Class .../home-care-agencies/orientation-class; Survey Program .../home-care-agencies/survey-program; Rules in Progress .../home-care-agencies/rules-progress; Fees .../home-care-agencies/fees; Contact Us .../home-care-agencies/contact-us
- DOH application packet 505-052 (April 2026): https://doh.wa.gov/sites/default/files/legacy/Documents/Pubs/505052.pdf — containing 505-053 (February 2026), 505-109 (April 2026), 505-051 (February 2026), 505-055 (June 2021) and 505-137 (June 2021)
- DOH survey tools and forms (PDFs at https://doh.wa.gov/sites/default/files/legacy/Documents/Pubs/NNNNNN.pdf, May 2018) [download — verify each is current]: home care deficiency checklist 346-099; policy and procedure checklist 505-141; bill of rights checklist 505-145; personnel checklist 655-014; client record review 505-152; long-term care worker checklist 346-097; hand hygiene policy example 505-144; plan of correction instructions 655-012; also the DOH tuberculosis risk assessment form (WAC 246-335-425(12)(c)) and the DOH mandatory-report form (425(8)(a)) [obtain — verify]

Ready to apply? Here is the next step.

44 policies | 50 forms | Editable Word + PDF

Every line on this checklist has a written policy and a form behind it in the Washington In-Home Services Agency Policy and Procedure Manual — Home Care (Non-Medical) Edition. Written to the text of Chapter 70.127 RCW and Chapter 246-335 WAC with every policy cited and the rule's own words in each one, a crosswalk from every requirement to the page that meets it, the application guide, and a "what to watch" layer for the points the rule leaves open.

Your checklist offer: 20% off the manual with code CHECKLIST20 (US$59 → US$47.20). Click